

ORDINANCES AND REGULATIONS

Ph.D. Programme



Indian Institute of Information Technology, Pune

AY 2024-25 onwards

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ORDINANCES & REGULATIONS FOR THE DEGREE OF DOCTOR OF PHILOSOPHY

PREAMBLE

Indian Institute of Information Technology Pune (IIIT Pune) offers postgraduate programmes leading to the award of PhD degrees through its Department. The award of the PhD degree is in recognition of high academic achievements, independent research and application of knowledge to the solution of technical and scientific problems in Computer Science and Engineering (CSE); Electronics and Communication Engineering (ECE); Applied Science & Humanities (ASH).

The academic programme leading to the Ph.D. degree is broad-based and involves a minimum course credit requirement and a research thesis. The institute also encourages interdisciplinary areas through a system of Co-supervision and provides excellent opportunities for such programs. The institute undertakes sponsored research and development projects from industrial and other organizations in the public as well as private sector.

The degree of Doctor of Philosophy shall be abbreviated as “PhD”. The degree of Doctor of Philosophy is granted for research work in areas recognized by the Academic Department of the institute subject to the conditions and regulations contained hereinafter.

The research work shall be an original work characterized either by the discovery of facts, by a fresh approach towards the interpretation and application of facts, or by the development of equipment making a distinct advancement in instrument technology. It shall evince the candidate’s capacity for critical examination and sound judgment and shall represent an original contribution to the existing knowledge.

The degree of Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) of the Indian Institute of Information Technology Pune shall be conferred on a candidate who fulfils all the requirements specified in these Ordinances and Regulations.

ORDINANCES FOR THE DEGREE OF DOCTOR OF PHILOSOPHY

DEFINITIONS

- (i) **“Applicant”** shall mean an individual who applies for admission to the PhD programme of IIIT Pune on a prescribed Application Form.
- (ii) **“Student”** shall mean a person registered for the Ph.D. degree.
- (iii) **“Supervisor”** shall mean a member of the academic staff of the Institute approved by the Director to supervise the research/ academic work of the student.
- (iv) **“Co-supervisor”** shall mean an additional supervisor approved by the Director on the recommendation of the Dean to help in the accomplishment of the research work of the student/candidate.
- (v) **“Course Advisor”** shall mean a faculty member nominated by the Dean to chalk out the programme of study of a student registered for the PhD and to advise him/her on the courses to be taken by him/her. If a supervisor (s) has already been appointed, he/she shall be the Courses Advisor for that student.
- (vi) **“Course work”** shall mean courses of study prescribed in the Department through the course Advisor to be undertaken by a student registered for the Ph.D. Degree.
- (vii) **“Dean”** shall mean the Dean of the Institute.
- (viii) **“Degree”** shall mean the Degree of Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) of the Indian Institute of Information Technology Pune.
- (ix) **“Minimum Registration Period”** shall mean the minimum period for which a candidate must be registered, including the time spent as a student before becoming a candidate, prior to submission of the thesis.
- (x) **“Registration Period”** shall mean the length of time span commencing with the date of initial registration at the institute.
- (xi) **“SRC”** shall mean Student Research Committee.

1. Ph.D. Programs Offered

IIIT Pune offers Ph.D. programs in the following disciplines:

- i. Computer Science and Engineering (CSE)
- ii. Electronics and Communication Engineering (ECE)
- iii. Applied Science & Humanities (ASH)

2. ADMISSION CATEGORIES:

The institute admits Ph.D. candidates under the following categories:

A. Industry Candidates:

- a. Extern Candidate from Industry (EX-I)
- b. Intern Sponsored Candidate from Industry (IN-IS)

B. Academic Institution(s) Candidates:

- a. Extern Self-financed candidates from Academic Institutions (EX-A)
- b. Intern Sponsored candidates from Academic Institutions (IN-AS)
- c. Extern Sponsored candidates from Academic Institutions (EX-AS)

C. Other Candidates:

- a. Intern self-sponsored Candidates (IN-U)
- b. Intern externally funded or sponsored or Project Staff Candidates (IN-ES)
- c. Intern self-sponsored project staff candidates SRF/JRF (IN-PS)

A. Industry Candidates:

a) Extern Candidate from Industry (EX-I)

This category shall include a candidate who is self-financed and permitted and employed by a recognized private/government/semi-government, R&D Organization, PSU, Private/ Government/semi-government Industry or companies or a Private/ government/semi-government non-academic institution for doing research in work integrated manner at the respective place of work. Such candidates are not eligible to receive any financial stipend or support from IIITP. At the time of admission, such candidates are required to submit NOC from the employer organization.

b) Intern Sponsored Candidate from Industry (IN-IS)

This category shall include a candidate who is sponsored and permitted and employed by a recognized private/ government/semi-government, R&D Organization, PSU, Private/ Government/semi-government Industry or companies or any Private/ government/semi-government non-academic institution for doing research at IIITP. Such a candidate is not eligible to receive any financial stipend or support from IIITP instead will be receiving the same from the sponsoring organization. It is mandatory for such candidates to present the certificate of financial assistance provided by the sponsoring organization. He/ She shall remain present at the IIIT Pune campus during the course of research.

B. Academic Institution(s) Candidates

a) Extern Self-financed candidates from Academic Institutions (EX-A):

This category shall include a candidate who is self-financed and permitted and employed by a recognized private (autonomous or university-affiliated)/ government (state or central)/semi-government academic institution for doing research in work integrated manner at the respective place of work. Such candidates are not eligible to receive any financial stipend or support from IIITP. At the time of admission, such candidates are required to submit NOC from an organization.

b) Intern Sponsored Candidate from Academic Institutions (IN-AS)

This category shall include a candidate who is sponsored and permitted and employed by a private (autonomous or university-affiliated)/ government (state or central)/semi-government academic institution or sponsored under QIP schemes for doing research at IIITP. Such a candidate is not eligible to receive any financial stipend or support from IIITP instead will be receiving the same from the sponsoring organization. It is mandatory for such candidates to present the certificate of financial assistance provided by the sponsoring organization. He/ She shall remain present at the IIIT Pune campus during the course of research.

c) Extern Sponsored Candidate from Academic Institutions (EX-AS)

The candidate must be an employee of the sponsoring organization. Such a candidate is not eligible to receive any financial stipend or support from IIITP instead will be

receiving the same from the sponsoring organization. It is mandatory for such candidates to present the certificate of financial assistance provided by the sponsoring organization.

C. Other Candidates:

a) Intern Self-Sponsored Candidates (IN-U)

This category shall include a candidate who is self-financed and unemployed. He/She shall remain present at the IIIT Pune campus during the course of research. The candidate is eligible for admission with a PG qualification. Such candidates are not eligible to receive any financial stipend or support from IIITP.

b) Intern Externally Funded or Sponsored or Project Staff Candidates (IN-ES)

This category shall include a candidate who has received a fellowship or scholarship or funding from Private trusts/Private industry/ Government or semi-government agency or department and is unemployed or a candidate working as SRF or JRF at IIITP under a funded research project will be doing research at IIITP. The candidate is eligible for admission with a PG qualification. Such candidates are not eligible to receive any financial stipend or support from IIITP. Instead in the case of SRF/JRF like IIITP project staff, the stipend will be under the respective research grant and for other candidates the stipend will be through the scholarships or fellowships they will be receiving. He/ She shall remain present at the IIIT Pune campus during the course of research.

c) Intern Self-Sponsored Project Staff Candidates SRF/JRF (IN-PS)

This category shall include a candidate who is working as SRF or JRF at IIITP under a funded research project and will be doing research at IIITP. The candidate is eligible for admission with a PG qualification. Such candidates are not eligible to receive any financial stipend or support from IIITP. Instead in the case of SRF/JRF like IIITP project staff, the stipend will be under the respective research grant. He/ She shall remain present at the IIIT Pune campus during the course of research.

3. ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA:

The relevant details of the eligibility criteria are as under:

For PhD in CSE and ECE

1. ME/M.Tech in relevant area **AND** minimum CGPA of 6.5 (6.0 for SC/ST/PwD) on a 10-point scale or 60% (55% marks for SC/ST/PwD) of marks or first class on the degree certificate.
(Minimum duration for PhD Thesis submission: 3 years)
2. BE/B.Tech in relevant area **AND** minimum CGPA of 6.5 (6.0 for SC/ST/PwD) on a 10-point scale or 60% (55% marks for SC/ST/PwD) of marks or first class on the degree certificate.
AND
 - a. completing graduation from CFTI/INI/Government Autonomous Institutes / Institute or University below 100 NIRF-ranking / Foreign Institutes with QS Ranking below 1000
OR
 - b. with valid GATE Score in CS/DA/EC/EE
OR
 - c. with minimum 3 years of relevant experience in allied fields.
(Minimum duration for PhD Thesis submission: 4 years)

For PhD in Applied Science & Humanities (ASH)

Sr No	Category	Minimum Duration for Thesis Submission	Eligibility
1	Candidate from Industry (EX-I) (IN-IS)	Three Academic years for candidates with a Master's degree and Four Academic years with a Bachelor's degree	Essential: 1. Master's Degree and Bachelor's Degree in Basic Science with First class or 60% marks (55% marks for SC / ST / PwD) / CPI or CGPA greater than 6 (5.5 for SC / ST / PwD) on a 10-point scale. AND 2. Minimum 1 year of relevant experience in relevant fields. OR 1. Bachelor's Degree in Basic Science with First Class or 60% marks (55% marks for SC / ST / PwD)/ CPI or CGPA greater than 6 (5.5 for SC/ST/PwD) on a 10-point scale. AND 3. Minimum 3 years of relevant experience in relevant fields.

			Desirable: A valid GATE/NET score is desired.
2	Academic Institution(s) Candidate (EX-A) (IN-AS) (EX-AS)	Three Academic years	Essential: Master's Degree in Basic Sciences with First class or 60% marks (55% marks for SC / ST / PwD) / CPI or CGPA greater than 6 (5.5 for SC / ST / PwD) on a 10-point scale. Desirable: A valid GATE/NET Score.
3	Other Candidates (IN-U) (IN-ES) (IN_PS)	Three Academic years	Essential: Master's degree in basic sciences or relevant area with Bachelor's degree in basic sciences and/or Allied Disciplines with First Class or 60% marks (55% marks for SC/ST/PwD) / CPI or CGPA greater than 6 (5.5 for SC/ST/PwD) on a 10-point scale. Desirable: A valid GATE/NET Score.

4. SELECTION PROCESS (ALL CATEGORIES):

Admission will be based on a written test and interview. The procedure will be as follows:

Stage 1: Written Test: Eligible candidates are required to appear for the written test.

Qualifying Score in Written Test:

The minimum qualifying score will be a normalized score decided taking into account the number of candidates to be called for an interview, but in no case it will be less than 40%. The normalization will be done by considering the topmost score to be 100% and scaling the scores of other candidates accordingly.

Stage 2: Interview: Candidates qualifying for the written test are required to appear for the Personal Interview.

Stage 3: A combined score will be calculated on the basis of the score in the written test and interview.

For admission, the following weightage will be considered.

PhD Category	Total Marks	Distribution	
		Written Test	Interview
EX-I	100	40	60
Ex-And Other Candidates	100	60	40

5. CREDIT REQUIREMENT:

All the registered PhD students need to complete the requirement of coursework of 6 credits by PG degree holders and 12 credits by UG degree holders in either of the following modes.

- Courses offered by the institute.
- Credits can be earned through successful completion of the online courses available on MOOC platforms like NPTEL/ MIT-OCW/Coursera/edX, etc. (The courses of 12 hours, 24 hours, and 36 hours will be considered as one credit, two credits, and three credits respectively). For higher credit courses, the number of hours will be on a pro-rata basis.
- Courses should be completed within a period of one and a half years from the date of registration.
- In addition to the existing credit requirements, the Research Methodology is a mandatory course to be successfully completed by every PhD student.

6. ASSESSMENT MECHANICS FOR ONLINE/MOOC COURSE:

- If the course work is done from SWAYAM then the consolidated score provided by the platform would be used for grading. In this case, the following table can be used for the award of grades.

Tentative range of marks obtained in the evaluation	Grades
81-100	AA
71-80	AB
61-70	BB
56-60	BC
51-55	CC
46-50	CD
40-45	DD
Below 40	FF

b. If the coursework is done from a platform other than the SWAYAM portal then the following procedure would be applicable.

i. Course accomplishment (25% weightage)

The candidate must successfully complete the registered online course as per the respective course evaluation criteria.

ii. Institute-level assessment (75% weightage)

An additional 100 Marks institute level assessment will be conducted and evaluated by the supervisor/course instructor for each such online course registered by the candidate.

iii. Final Score

The final score of the online courses is evaluated on the basis of a combined weighted score secured in both online assessment and Institute-level assessment as follows.

Final Score= 0.25 (Score obtained through online assessment) + 0.75 (Score obtained through Institute-level assessment)

7. COMPOSITION OF SRC:

The Student Research Committee (SRC) required to be set up for monitoring the progress of research for each registered scholar shall have the following composition.

- i. **Chairman** - Head of the concerned Department/ One of the senior qualified supervisors nominated by the Chairman Senate.
- ii. **Supervisor/Supervisors.**
- iii. **One/Two SRC Members** - Expert from the Allied Department/ Discipline/ Industry/ other reputed academic institutes to be nominated by the supervisor.
- iv. **Invited Member** - A scholar can have an invited member as a part of his SRC who can be a co-author in the research papers/patents. The invited member should be an Associate Professor / Professor from CFTI / INI / Government Autonomous Research Institutes / Govt. Research Organizations / Foreign Institutes with QS Ranking below 1000. The supervisor shall take the consent and approval for the selection of the invited member, through proper channels, from the Dean.
- v. **External SRC Member** - A scholar can opt for an external SRC member if he/she is an expert in the area in which the scholar is working. An SRC member cannot be a co-author in publication. The supervisor can take consent and approval for the selection of the invited member, through proper channels, from the Dean.

8. **MAXIMUM NUMBER OF CANDIDATES A SUPERVISOR CAN GUIDE:**

A supervisor can have 8-10 candidates registered under him/her for Ph.D. (candidate count shall be considered as; Joint Supervision=0.5, Standalone Supervision= 1). However, the external candidate must be from CFTI or INI institutions, and at any point in time, the number of scholars from other institutes shall be less than or equal to the number of internal scholars.

9. **CHANGE OF SUPERVISOR:**

1. If the supervisor of a Ph.D. scholar proceeds on leave for a period of more than 12 months and if there is no co-supervisor then, a co-supervisor will be appointed on the recommendations of the SRC, who will look after the interests of the Ph.D. scholar in

absence of the Supervisor.

2. If the supervisor of a Ph.D. scholar resigns or expires or is terminated or is under suspension from the Institute service, he/she shall cease to be the supervisor.
3. In all the above cases, where the existing supervisor of a PhD scholar ceases to be the supervisor, the SRC shall appoint the co-supervisor, if any, as the supervisor of the candidate, provided the co-supervisor is from the same discipline and is otherwise eligible. If there is no co-supervisor for the concerned Ph.D. scholar or the co-supervisor is from a different discipline or if the co-supervisor is not eligible, then the Director shall appoint a new supervisor, on recommendations of the SRC.
4. If a Ph.D. scholar applies for a change of Ph. D. supervisor, along with the No Objection Certificate from the present Supervisor and consent from the proposed Supervisor then his/her request will be considered by the SRC and if found to have merit, a new supervisor shall be appointed in place of the existing one, with the concurrence of Dean and approval of the Director.
5. If a supervisor expresses an inability to supervise the research work of a PhD scholar who is registered with him/her, an application from the supervisor stating his inability shall be considered by the SRC and if found to have merit, a new supervisor will be appointed for the Ph.D. scholar in place of the existing one, after due concurrence of the Dean and approval of the Director.

10. SEMESTER BREAK:

1. Due to any genuine reasons, a scholar can opt for a semester break for which he/she has to submit such an application with supporting documents forwarded through the PhD Coordinator, HoD and Dean to the Director. Such break will be allowed only subject to receiving approval from the Director and only one such break will be allowed during the entire duration of Ph.D. A scholar is not required to pay the fees and present the progress seminar of that semester break.
2. A research scholar must follow the schedule of course/seminar registration schedule every semester and also the schedule of progress seminar presentations without fail. Any kind of delay resulting in missing the deadline may make scholars pay the fine subject to the approval from the Dean and Director.

11. VALIDITY OF REGISTRATION:

1. The registration will be valid for a period of **7 years** from the date of registration and no further extension will be granted under normal circumstances.
2. After 7 years, if a candidate wishes to continue research, he/she will be required to register again. A candidate should apply for re-registration before completion of the 7-year of registration period. Failure to do so a candidate will be required to register again following the procedure for fresh candidates.

12. LEAVE REGULATIONS FOR FULL-TIME / SPONSORED (FULL-TIME) PHD. SCHOLARS WITH FINANCIAL SUPPORT:

1. A full-time/ sponsored (full-time) PhD scholar, during his/her stay at the Institute, will be entitled to 30 days leave during each academic year, including leave on medical grounds. These scholars are not entitled to have a vacation. Even during mid-semester breaks and summer and winter vacations, he/she will have to explicitly apply for leave. Leave beyond 30 days in an academic year may be granted to a research scholar in exceptional cases subject to the following conditions:
 - i. that the leave beyond 30 days will be without Assistantship/Scholarship, and
 - ii. Such an extension of up to an additional 30 days will be granted only once during the entire program of the scholar including self-sponsored scholar.
2. The female Ph.D. Scholars are entitled to Maternity leave for a maximum period of 180 days. In such cases, the PhD registration period, which is valid for seven years as per the norms of the Institute, will further be extended for the period of maternity leave availed (not exceeding 180 days).

Research scholars shall submit the application for leave along with a copy of the appropriate medical certificate through the Supervisor, PhD Coordinator, HoD and to the Dean for approval.

Note: For full-time external candidates above leave regulations are not applicable.

13. ABSENCE DURING THE SEMESTER FOR COURSES REGISTERED:

- i. A scholar must inform the Supervisor, PhD Coordinator, HoD and Dean immediately of an instance of continuous absence from coursework.
- ii. A scholar who is absent due to illness or any other unavoidable circumstances, for up to a maximum of two weeks, should approach the course coordinator for make-up quizzes, assignments and laboratory work. Supporting documents should be attached to the application.
- iii. A scholar absent from a sessional examination due to illness should approach the course coordinator for a make-up test immediately on return to class. The request should be supported with a medical certificate from the Institute's Medical Officer. A certificate from a registered medical practitioner will also be acceptable for a scholar normally residing off-campus, provided details of registration of the concerned Medical Practitioner appear explicitly on the certificate.
- iv. In case the period of absence on medical grounds is more than 20 working days during the semester, a scholar may apply for withdrawal from the semester, i.e. withdrawal from all courses registered in that semester. Such applications must be submitted as early as possible and latest one week before the start of the End Term Examination. No applications for semester withdrawal will be considered thereafter. Depending on the merit of the case, the Dean will consider such applications. Partial withdrawal from courses registered in a semester is not allowed.
- v. If a scholar is continuously absent from the institute for more than four weeks without notifying the Supervisor / PhD Coordinator/ HoD / Dean, his/her name will be removed from the institute rolls.

14. PROGRESS SEMINAR:

1. A scholar is required to give a progress seminar on his/her project work every six months in the concerned department during the PhD seminar weeks indicated in the academic calendar.
2. The time-line for six monthly seminars shall be as per the academic calendar. A brief write-up outlining the work previously done, the current status and the future plans also should be submitted to the SRC members at least 3 days prior to

the date of the seminar.

3. Report of the SRC after each six-monthly progress seminar shall be duly forwarded to the office of the Dean/PhD Coordinator by the concerned department, in a format available on the website.
4. Six monthly seminars shall be conducted only if the semester fee is paid. No further seminar shall be conducted without payment of fees.
5. A report of six-monthly seminars is required to be submitted to the Dean's office **within 15 days after** the last date of delivering the seminar mentioned in the academic calendar. The consolidated summary sheet along with copies of seminar reports and other documents of all candidates should be sent in a single lot. Individual seminar reports of candidates will not be accepted.
6. A candidate is supposed to earn satisfactory remarks from the SRC after presenting the progress seminar. On getting two consecutive unsatisfactory remarks; the candidate may be liable for registration cancellation if the explanation and undertaking submitted by him/her are not satisfactory. Moreover, if a PhD student remains absent for the PhD progress seminar on two occasions without prior approval, the registration in PhD programme will be terminated.

15. PRE-SUBMISSION SEMINAR

1. In case there is a need to organize a pre-submission Seminar of PhD scholars before the completion of the minimum duration for PhD thesis submission, such pre-submission seminars may be permitted up to the duration of one month before the completion of the minimum duration.
2. The PhD coordinator needs to issue a notice of pre-submission seminar through the departmental HoD with a copy to the SRC, Dean and Director at least one week in advance.
3. A copy of the synopsis should be submitted to the SRC members at least one week prior to the pre-submission seminar date.
4. The pre-submission seminar report along with the undertaking for publication should be submitted to the Dean's office/ PhD Coordinator for further processing.
5. The presentation of the pre-submission seminar should be in tune with the thesis

and should be like a precursor to the final defense.

6. Faculty members and Ph.D. scholars of the respective department should attend the pre-submission seminar in large numbers.

16. REQUIREMENTS FOR SUBMISSION OF THESIS:

- i. The research work shall be supported by two publications of research papers in quality journals (SCI/SCIE/SSCI/Scopus).
- ii. A scholar shall be required to deliver a pre-submission seminar and will be allowed to submit his/her thesis only if the SRC recommends it.
- iii. The thesis should be shown to SRC members. Preferably the thesis should be ready before delivering the pre-submission seminar, so SRC members will go through the facts and figures of the thesis.
- iv. The thesis will be required to be submitted within six months from the date of delivery of the pre-submission seminar.
- v. A candidate is required to submit 3 copies of the synopsis and 3 copies of the softbound PhD thesis along with the soft copies of the synopsis and thesis in PDF format to the Academic Section.

17. PH.D. THESIS EVALUATION:

- i. The candidate needs to pay PhD thesis evaluation Fees of Rs 35,000/- (Rs Thirty-Five Thousand Only). It will be utilized for the Thesis Evaluation honorarium of examiners, Defense Examination, TA, DA of external Examiner etc.
- ii. The thesis shall be evaluated by two examiners nominated by the Chairman Senate from the panel of examiners suggested by the Supervisor and forwarded through the HoD. One external examiner from outside India is desirable.
- iii. The supervisor will be notified once all the reviews of the thesis are available for further action by the Registrar's Office/ Academic Section.
- iv. Candidates shall be provided a copy of detailed reports of both examiners by the supervisor.
- v. If both the examiners give favourable reports, the candidate will be eligible for

PhD degree after an open defense and recommendation of the Senate.

- vi. If the examiner(s) recommends acceptance of the thesis subject to major modifications, the thesis can be resubmitted only once after incorporating the modifications, within a period of one year. The thesis so resubmitted shall be examined by the same examiner(s).
- vii. If the examiner(s) recommend acceptance of the thesis with minor modifications only, the thesis is to be corrected before open defense and viva-voce. The external examiner shall confirm whether corrections suggested by both examiners are included.
- viii. In case, the report of one of the examiners is not favorable, the thesis will be sent to the third examiner. If the report of the third examiner is favourable then only a candidate will be considered eligible for PhD degree after open defense.
- ix. A candidate shall be required to defend his/her PhD thesis (open defense and viva-voce) before the Board of Examiners consisting of the following members:
 - i) One of the Examiners of the Ph.D. thesis
 - ii) Head of the concerned Department.
 - iii) Supervisor(s) of Ph.D. thesis.
 - iv) Director's Nominee (from amongst the Ph.D. Supervisors from another Department)
 - v) SRC member(s)

In case the examiner is unable to attend the viva-voce for any reason either in offline or online mode, the Director is empowered to nominate one expert in the field from the local area as an examiner.

- x. A candidate will have to submit two hardbound copies of the thesis incorporating all suggestions of examiners after a successful defense, one for the record, and the other for the library along with the soft copies in a pen drive.
- xi. A softcopy of the thesis should also be uploaded on to Shodhganga platform through the institute library.
- xii. The thesis rejected by both examiners may be resubmitted after revision, not earlier than one year and not later than three years from the date of such intimation to the scholar by the Academic Section. The thesis so resubmitted may

be examined by the same referees or by new referees.

- xiii. Rejection of the thesis so resubmitted will disqualify the scholar from further consideration for the award of the Ph.D. degree, in the topic of research chosen by him/her.
- xiv. On the basis of the report of the Board of Examiners, the Senate decides the scholar's eligibility for the award of the degree of Doctor of Philosophy

18. CANCELLATION OF REGISTRATION:

Candidates alone or supervisor with SRC or candidate and supervisor(s) can apply for cancellation. The PhD Coordinator, HoD and Dean shall recommend the cancellation to the Director for approval.